THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE TEMPLATE

The Legacy Brief

A five-page template for starting a family business on purpose, with AI doing the heavy lifting, so the next generation does not start from scratch.

You may not come from a wealthy family. A wealthy family can come from you.

Hand down more than money.

Money gets spent. What lasts is the mindset, the skill set and the tool set that let a family keep building.

Most families never write this down, so it gets passed on by accident or not at all. A family business is one way to pass it on deliberately: children who watch a business being built learn how, long before they are asked to start their own.

It used to need a team

A family business meant staff, offices and capital that most families could not gather.

Now it can start small

With AI doing the research, drafting and admin, one household can begin with a laptop and a clear plan.

This brief gives you the questions to answer, a first project, and a ninety-day plan. Write in pencil. You can change it.

Start where you are. Write it down.

Mindset, skill set, tool set.

MINDSET	**How we think about building.** What do you want them to believe about work, patience, honesty, risk and giving? Write three sentences you would be proud to hear them say.
SKILL SET	**What they can actually do.** Selling, making, writing, numbers, speaking, managing people. Which three would most change their options? Which can they start learning this year?
TOOL SET	**What they can use.** The accounts, tools and systems the family already has, and the AI tools they can learn alongside you. Write what exists today, not what you wish existed.

Your three, today

MINDSET: _____

SKILL SET: _____

TOOL SET: _____

Start small, start together.

The first family project should be small enough to finish in ninety days and real enough that someone pays for it.

1 FIND THE PROJECT

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Our family is [describe: who, ages, location]. Our skills are [list].
Our interests are [list]. We have [hours per week] to spend and
[budget] to start. Suggest five small business ideas we could start
together that fit those skills, interests and hours, can be run
mostly from home, and are honest, legal and sell something real. For
each, tell me the first customer, the first week's action, and what
could go wrong. Do not invent numbers or promise income.
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2 PRESSURE-TEST IT

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We are thinking of starting: [idea]. Act as a skeptical advisor. Tell
me who would pay, why they would pick us, what the real costs are,
what the main risks are, and the smallest, cheapest test we could run
to find out if people want it before we commit. Be direct.
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Ask each family member what part they would like to own. A role they chose will last longer than one they were given.

Everyone gets a real job.

YOU	**Director.** You set the standard and make the final decisions, and you explain why you made them.
THE CHILDREN	**A real task, sized to them.** Choosing a name, checking the product, answering a customer message with you. Let them see the whole loop, not just a chore.
YOUR PARTNER	**The role they choose.** Decide it together and write it down.
AI	**The workforce.** Research, first drafts, admin and follow-up, so the humans spend their time on judgement and on each other.

3 THE FAMILY CHARTER

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Here is how our family wants to run this business: our values are
[list], our roles are [list], and we want to teach our children
[skills]. Write a one-page family charter in plain, warm language
that covers: what we make and for whom, how we treat customers, how
decisions are made, what we will never do, and what we want the
children to learn. Leave blanks for anything I have not told you.
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The first ninety days.

DAYS 1 TO 14	**Write it.** Complete pages 2 to 4. Choose the project and the roles. Run the pressure-test prompt.
DAYS 15 TO 45	**Make the first version.** The smallest thing a customer could buy or use. Let the children help with something they can see.
DAYS 46 TO 75	**Find the first customer.** Show it to real people, listen, change one thing each week.
DAYS 76 TO 90	**Review as a family.** What worked, what the children learned, what next. Keep it, change it or stop it, openly.

THE FAMILY REVIEW

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Here is what happened in our first ninety days: [notes]. Summarise
what worked and what did not, what each of us learned, and the three
decisions we should make next. Write one paragraph we could read
aloud to the family.
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A planning template, not legal, tax or financial advice. For anything involving ownership, property, inheritance or tax, speak to a qualified professional where you live.

Your children do not have to start from scratch.